

Saturday, 11 July 2026.

Your daily radio show prep — three top news stories, forward-looking showbiz, sport that matters this week, talkback prompts, and day notes for today and tomorrow. Built fresh every weekday, ready by 3pm for tomorrow's show.

00 — WEATHER

Tomorrow's forecast

BIRMINGHAM Partly cloudy 30° 19°	MANCHESTER Mostly clear 29° 20°	GLASGOW Drizzle 21° 16°
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01 — NEWS

Today's top stories

- 1

The historic Bayeux Tapestry has arrived in the UK for the first time in 900 years, travelling under tight police guard.

This incredible artefact, depicting the events leading up to the Norman Conquest, will go on display to the public in September. It's a huge moment for British history and culture.

HISTORY · UK
- 2

The UK is sweltering in 35-degree heat, with millions now facing hosepipe bans as the hot spell continues.

Thursday saw temperatures exceed 34 degrees for the eighth day this year, breaking a previous record. Anglian Water is the latest to introduce a temporary ban in the country's driest region.

WEATHER · UK
- 3

Andy Burnham is set to become the next Labour leader after securing nominations from 322 MPs, making him unopposed in the race.

The former Mayor of Greater Manchester will replace Sir Keir Starmer. This means he is likely to become Prime Minister, with Labour currently ahead in the polls.

POLITICS · UK
- 4

New proposals could see vape companies banned from using enticing names and flavours to protect children.

The government is consulting on plans to stop descriptions that might attract youngsters to experiment with vaping. It's hoped this will curb the growing trend among under-18s.

HEALTH · UK
- 5

Watch out for those 'too good to be true' portable air conditioner adverts sweeping the internet, says the Advertising Standards Authority.

The ASA warns that claims small devices can cool rooms in 90 seconds are misleading. Many people are looking for ways to stay cool in the current heatwave.

CONSUMER · UK

What's coming up

- 1 The historic Bayeux Tapestry has arrived in the UK for the first time in 900 years, ready for a major exhibition.**
This incredible artefact, depicting the events leading up to the Norman Conquest, will go on public display in September. It's sure to be a huge draw for history buffs and art lovers alike.
ON AIR – Are you excited to see the Bayeux Tapestry in person? What's the oldest artefact you've ever seen?
EXHIBITION · AUTUMN
- 2 Spice Girls star Melanie C says the band's 30th anniversary celebrations have been incredibly 'emotional' for her.**
Sporty Spice reflected on the group's amazing legacy as she picked up a global impact award in London. Fans are still hoping for a full reunion tour to mark the milestone!
ON AIR – What's your all-time favourite Spice Girls song, and why?
MUSIC · ANNIVERSARY
- 3 The Duchess of Sophie has made a surprise cameo appearance in the much-loved radio drama, The Archers!**
Sophie headed to Birmingham to record with the Ambridge regulars for Thursday's episode. It's not every day you get royalty in Dorsetshire!
ON AIR – Have you heard the Duchess's cameo in The Archers? Which other Royal would you like to hear in a soap?
ROYALTY · THIS WEEK
- 4 Presenter Greg James has spilled some of the details from Taylor Swift's wedding, including 'multiple cakes'!**
The DJ shared insights on his morning show after flying to New York City for the star-studded event. Sounds like it was quite the celebration!
ON AIR – If you could invite any celebrity to your wedding, who would it be?
CELEBRITY · RECENTLY
- 5 A collection of J.R.R. Tolkien's fan letters, books, and notes have sold at auction for an astonishing £103,000.**
The items documented the unique friendship between the legendary author and a profoundly deaf fan. It shows the incredible connection Tolkien had with his readers.
ON AIR – Have you ever written a fan letter to an author or celebrity? Did you get a reply?
BOOKS · RECENTLY

On the schedule

1 **British wildcard Arthur Fery's incredible Wimbledon journey has come to an end, beaten by Alexander Zverev in the semi-finals.**

Fery put up a valiant fight, but Zverev secured his place in the final. Despite the loss, it's been an unforgettable run for the young Brit.

ON AIR – What an amazing run for Arthur Fery! Do you think he's got a big future in tennis?

TENNIS · UK

2 **England are preparing to face Norway in a World Cup quarter-final on Saturday, with all eyes on how to stop star striker Erling Haaland.**

Thomas Tuchel's side will need a solid plan to handle the main threat from the Norwegian forward. It promises to be a thrilling match!

ON AIR – How do you think England will manage to contain Erling Haaland in tomorrow's game?

FOOTBALL · UK

3 **Manchester City have signed England international Niamh Charles from Women's Super League rivals Chelsea for £500,000.**

It's a big move for the defender, as she switches from one top club to another. This transfer window is certainly heating up!

ON AIR – Which women's football transfer has surprised you the most this season?

FOOTBALL · UK

4 **World number one Scottie Scheffler has missed the cut at the Scottish Open for the first time in 79 tournaments.**

He bogeyed the final hole of his second round, leading to an early exit. It's a rare stumble for the usually consistent golfer.

ON AIR – Were you surprised to see Scottie Scheffler miss the cut? Does it make the tournament more exciting?

GOLF · UK

5 **England have thrashed India by nine wickets in Bristol, with Harry Brook shining to secure a T20 series win.**

Brook hit an unbeaten 79, guiding England to a dominant victory. They now lead the five-match series 3-0, securing their first T20 series win against India.

ON AIR – What a performance from Harry Brook! Who do you think was England's player of the series?

CRICKET · UK

Quick hits

- 1 A recent study suggests that the simple act of 'doodling while on the phone' can actually improve memory retention.**
Researchers found that participants who doodled remembered 29% more information from a monotonous message than those who just listened. So, next time you're on hold, grab a pen!
- 2 The comforting appeal of 'collecting old railway timetables' is seeing a gentle resurgence among history buffs.**
It seems there's something charming about poring over the intricate schedules of bygone train journeys, offering a nostalgic glimpse into travel history.
- 3 Interest in 'identifying different types of clouds' is encouraging more people to look up and appreciate the sky.**
From fluffy cumulus to wispy cirrus, sky-gazing is becoming a popular, free pastime, offering a moment of calm in busy days.
- 4 A charming trend for 'decorating garden gnomes' is turning them into unique works of art.**
Gardeners are giving their gnomes makeovers with tiny outfits, paint, and accessories, adding a touch of personality to their outdoor spaces.
- 5 The humble 'rubber band' is being hailed as a surprisingly versatile household item beyond holding things together.**
From keeping cupboard doors shut to marking your place in a book, its practical uses are seemingly endless, proving that simple solutions are often the best.
- 6 A new appreciation for 'vintage typewriters' is encouraging a return to more focused writing.**
Many writers are finding the tactile experience and lack of digital distractions help them concentrate better, creating a unique connection with their words.
- 7 The delightful trend of 'swapping small, handmade gifts' within local communities is fostering neighbourly spirit.**
Whether it's a home-baked treat or a handcrafted bookmark, these little gestures are strengthening local bonds and spreading smiles.

05 – TALKBACK

For the phone lines

OUR SURVEY SAID

Q Our survey said that over 70% of us admit to secretly 'doing' what with our socks after washing, even though we know it's a bit odd?

ANSWER: TRYING TO MATCH THEM UP USING ONLY THE SENSE OF TOUCH!

Q Our survey said that over 65% of us admit to having a particular 'ritual' they absolutely have to do before settling down to watch a favourite TV show. What is it?

ANSWER: ARRANGING ALL THE CUSHIONS ON THE SOFA IN A VERY SPECIFIC ORDER.

TALK TOPIC

- You know how sometimes you stumble upon an 'old photograph' and it instantly transports you back to that moment, perhaps even making you smell something familiar?

What's the most vivid memory an old photo has ever brought back for you, and what made it so powerful?

- We all have those 'little tricks' we use to make everyday chores a bit more bearable or even enjoyable, don't we?

What's your cleverest or funniest 'hack' for tackling a household chore, that others might find surprisingly useful?

TRUE STORY OR JACKANORY – LISTENERS GUESS

FACT **Animals.** Did you know that a group of owls is called a parliament?

FICTION **Made up, but believable.** Did you know that a group of squirrels is called a chittering?

06 – LOTTERY

Jackpots ahead

NEXT EUROMILLIONS JACKPOT

£6.6 million

Next Tuesday or Friday · estimated

NEXT NATIONAL LOTTERY JACKPOT

£6.6 million

Next Wednesday or Saturday · estimated

07 – FACTS OF THE DAY

Did you know?

- A 'jiffy' is an actual unit of time, equal to one hundredth of a second.
- The longest place name in the UK is Llanfairpwllgwyngyllgogerychwyrndrobwlllantysiliogogogoch, a village in Wales.
- Bumblebees can fly higher than Mount Everest, if they could actually breathe up there.
- The inventor of the corkscrew was a British clergyman named Samuel Henshall in 1795.
- Strawberries are the only fruit that wear their seeds on the outside.
- A 'squawk' of gulls is a commonly used collective noun for a group of these birds.
- The British Isles are home to over 40 species of native trees.
- The first crossword puzzle was published in a newspaper in New York on December 21, 1913.

On this day

Day 192 of the year, 173 days left in 2026. Today Christian Feast Day: Benedict of Nursia; Christian Feast Day: Drostan; Christian Feast Day: Kjeld; Christian Feast Day: Marciana of Toledo. Star sign Cancer, birthstone Ruby.

TODAY'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1972 — Cormac Battle, English-Irish singer-songwriter, guitarist, and producer
- 1953 — Peter Brown, American singer-songwriter and producer
- 1973 — Andrew Bird, American indie rock singer-songwriter and violinist
- 1964 — Craig Charles, English actor and TV presenter
- 1958 — Mark Lester, English actor
- 1952 — Stephen Lang, American actor and playwright
- 1966 — Ricky Warwick, Northern Irish musician
- 1943 — Tom Holland, American actor, director, and screenwriter

THE DAY TODAY

- 1950 — Pakistan joins the International Monetary Fund and the International Bank.
- 2021 — Virgin Galactic launches its founder, Richard Branson, into space, the first company ever to do so.
- 1972 — The first game of the World Chess Championship 1972 between challenger Bobby Fischer and defending champion Boris Spassky starts.

TODAY IN MUSIC

- 1995 — Yugoslav Wars: Srebrenica massacre begins, lasting until 22 July.
- 1983 — A TAME airline Boeing 737-200 crashes near Cuenca, Ecuador, killing all 119 passengers and crew on board.

TODAY IN HISTORY

- 1943 — Massacres of Poles in Volhynia and Eastern Galicia by the Ukrainian Insurgent Army within the Reichskommissariat Ukraine (Volhynia) peak.
- 1982 — Italy defeats West Germany 3–1 to win the FIFA World Cup.

1962 — Project Apollo: At a press conference, NASA announces lunar orbit rendezvous as the means to land astronauts on the Moon, and return them to Earth.

A peek at tomorrow

Day 193 of the year, 172 days left in 2026. Today Christian feast day: Feast of Saints Peter and Paul (Eastern Orthodox); Christian feast day: Hermagoras and Fortunatus; Christian feast day: Jason of Thessalonica (Catholic Church); Christian feast day: John Gualbert. Star sign Cancer, birthstone Ruby.

TOMORROW'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1962 — Dan Murphy, American musician
- 1955 — Timothy Garton Ash, English historian and author
- 1942 — Swamp Dogg, American R&B singer-songwriter and musician
- 1992 — Luke Berry, English footballer
- 1964 — Gaby Roslin, English television host and actress
- 1959 — Charlie Murphy, American actor and comedian (died 2017)
- 1969 — Jesse Pintado, Mexican-American guitarist (died 2006)
- 1976 — Tracie Spencer, American singer-songwriter and actress

THE DAY TOMORROW

- 1920 — The Soviet–Lithuanian Peace Treaty is signed, by which Soviet Russia recognizes the independence of Lithuania.
- 2013 — Six people are killed and 200 injured in a French passenger train derailment in Brétigny-sur-Orge.
- 1973 — A fire destroys the entire sixth floor of the National Personnel Records Center of the United States.

TOMORROW IN MUSIC

- 2024 — Gazpromavia Flight 9608 crashes in Russia's Kolomensky District near Kolomna, killing three.
- 2012 — A tank truck explosion kills more than 100 people in Okobie, Nigeria.

Coming to cinemas

JULY 2026	
FRI 17	Christopher Nolan's The Odyssey (+ IMAX); Cut Off
FRI 24	Heads of State; Untitled DCU
FRI 31	Spider-Man: Brand New Day

AUGUST 2026	
FRI 7	Once Upon a Time in a Cinema
FRI 14	Flowervale Street; PAW Patrol 3: The Dino Movie
FRI 21	Mutiny; The Bride!
FRI 28	Crime 101; Outcome

SEPTEMBER 2026 • PREVIEW	
FRI 4	Conjuring: Last Rites
FRI 11	Resident Evil reboot
FRI 18	The Black Phone 2
FRI 25	Tron: Ares (+ IMAX)

OCTOBER 2026 • PREVIEW	
FRI 16	Untitled Christopher McQuarrie thriller
FRI 23	Frankenstein (del Toro)

On the sporting calendar

JULY 2026	
4–26 JUL	Tour de France (Cycling)
16–19 JUL	The Open Championship (Golf)
18–26 JUL	World Matchplay Darts, Blackpool
23 JUL – 2 AUG	Commonwealth Games, Glasgow
AUGUST 2026	
W/C 10	Hundred & T20 Blast climax (Cricket)
SAT 15	Premier League season begins (2026/27)
22–23	Belgian Grand Prix (F1)